

A flamingolike diet of brine shrimp may have given *Pterodaustro* a pinkish hue.

STATS AND FACTS

The bristly structures in *Pterodaustro*'s mouth resemble the baleen plates that line the jaws of modern filter-feeding whales. However, studies of these structures tell us that they are not plates at all, but simply specialized teeth made up of the same materials as the teeth of most other animals.

TINY UPPER TEETH



Measuring just $\frac{1}{32}$ in (1 mm) across, the teeth in the upper jaw were only used to crush prey.

COMMON PTEROSAUR



With 300 known fossils, this pterosaur is one of the best known from South America.

Pterodaustro's wings could fold up against its body when it was on the ground.

AT A GLANCE

- **WINGSPAN** 8 ft (2.5 m)
- **DIET** Carnivore
- **LIVED** 113–101 MYA
- **HABITAT** Lakes and coasts

